

AB-731 Lab Workbook (M365 Copilot Only)

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Overview

This workbook contains four hands-on labs designed for students who have a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, but do not have access to Microsoft Foundry/Azure AI Studio. The labs focus on prompt engineering, document-grounded assistance, meeting intelligence, end-to-end workflows across Microsoft 365 apps, governance/security behavior, and creating a declarative agent in Copilot Chat.

Important Note — Using Documents in These Labs

Recommended (full functionality)

- Upload documents to OneDrive or SharePoint.
- This enables grounded answers, cross-document queries, persistent knowledge, and best results.

Local files (limited support)

- You can open a document in Word/Excel/PowerPoint and use Copilot on that file.
- This only works within that file; cross-document grounding and persistent knowledge are limited.
- Conclusion: Local files are acceptable for practice. OneDrive/SharePoint is required for realistic enterprise scenarios.

Suggested Files

If your instructor provided a sample document pack, upload those files to a folder named 'AB731-Labs' in OneDrive. If you do not have the pack, you may use your own documents instead.

Lab 1 — Prompt Engineering in Word

Objective

Control Copilot output using structured prompts, constraints, and rewrite instructions.

Document Use

Works with OneDrive or a local file. OneDrive is preferred.

Steps

1. Open 'Remote_Work_Policy.docx' in Word (web or desktop).
2. Open Copilot.
3. Run the basic prompt.

Basic prompt:

Summarize this document

4. Run the structured prompt and verify it uses only the document.

Structured prompt:

Summarize this policy as:

- 5 key rules
- 3 security requirements
- 2 manager responsibilities

Only use information from the document.

If something is not stated, say "Not stated".

5. Run the rewrite prompt.

Rewrite prompt:

Rewrite this as a one-page employee guide with headings and bullet points.

6. Save your output as 'Lab1_RemoteWork_QuickGuide.docx'.

Expected Outcome

- A short summary and a structured summary.
- A one-page employee guide derived from the policy.
- Clear use of constraints such as 'Not stated' where applicable.

Extension (optional)

- Create a 6-question FAQ based only on the document, using 'Not stated' when needed.
- Ask Copilot to produce an 'Executive summary' version limited to 120 words.

Lab 2 — Meeting Analysis with Copilot

Objective

Extract decisions and action items from a meeting transcript and draft a professional follow-up email.

Document Use

Works with OneDrive or a local file.

Steps

7. Open 'Meeting_Transcript_Excerpt.docx' in Word.
8. Open Copilot.
9. Generate a concise meeting summary.

Prompt:

Summarize key decisions in bullet points.

10. Extract action items in a structured format.

Prompt:

Extract action items with: Owner, Deadline. If not stated, write "Not stated".

11. Draft a follow-up email to attendees.

Prompt:

Draft a follow-up email summarizing the meeting and listing action items.

12. Save outputs as 'Lab2_Meeting_Summary_and_FollowUp.docx'.

Expected Outcome

- A bullet summary of decisions.
- A structured list of action items with owners and deadlines.
- A ready-to-send follow-up email draft.

Extension (optional)

- Add a 'Risks and mitigations' section based only on transcript content.
- Ask Copilot to create a short agenda for the next meeting based on open action items.

Lab 3 — End-to-End HR Workflow (Word → PowerPoint → Outlook)

For discussion only

Objective

Create a policy briefing in Word, convert it to slides in PowerPoint, and draft a manager announcement email in Outlook.

Document Use

Strongly recommended: OneDrive/SharePoint for best cross-app context. Local files may work per app but with reduced continuity.

Steps

13. In OneDrive, ensure the policy documents are available in a folder named 'AB731-Labs' (or use your own documents).

14. Open Word and create a new document named 'Policy_Highlights.docx'.

15. Use Copilot to generate the briefing using your policy documents.

Prompt:

Create a 1-page HR policy highlights briefing using the HR policy documents available to me.

Sections:

1) Leave

2) Remote work expectations + security

3) Business travel approvals + expenses

Use short bullets and clear headings. Use only the documents.

16. Save the Word document.

17. Open PowerPoint and use Copilot to create a 6-slide deck from 'Policy_Highlights.docx'.

Prompt:

Create a 6-slide presentation from Policy_Highlights.docx.

Slides: Title, Leave, Remote Work, Security, Travel, Summary/Next steps.

18. Open Outlook and use Copilot to draft an email to managers and reference attaching the presentation.

Prompt:

Draft an email to managers announcing the policy highlights. Include 3 key takeaways and a call to action. Keep tone formal and concise.

19. Save the email draft (do not send unless instructed).

Expected Outcome

- A one-page policy highlights briefing in Word.
- A 6-slide PowerPoint presentation derived from the briefing.
- A concise Outlook email draft to managers.

Extension (optional)

- Ask Copilot to produce a 5-question employee quiz based only on the policies.
- Create a second deck for employees with simpler language and more examples.

Lab 4 — Create a Declarative Agent in Copilot Chat

Objective

Create a reusable declarative agent in Copilot Chat grounded on policy documents.

Document Use

Recommended: Use OneDrive/SharePoint for persistent agent knowledge. Local file upload may be possible for quick testing in a session, but it is not persistent and is not a strong reusable agent pattern.

Steps

20. Open Copilot Chat (work mode).
21. Create a new agent (Agents → Create agent).
22. Set Name: 'HR Policy Agent'.
23. Add instructions (copy/paste).

Instructions to paste:
You are an HR assistant.

Rules:

- Only answer using provided documents
- If information is missing, say: "I cannot find that in the provided documents"
- Use bullet points
- Be concise and professional
- Do not guess or hallucinate

Scope:

- HR topics only

24. Add knowledge: select the policy documents from OneDrive/SharePoint (or your own documents).
25. Save the agent and open it.
26. Test prompts:

Test prompts:

- 1) What is the vacation entitlement?
- 2) What are the key remote work security requirements?
- 3) What is the Mars travel policy? (should respond that it cannot find it)

27. Document your observations: where it stayed grounded and how it handled missing info.

Expected Outcome

- A working declarative agent with clear scope and grounding rules.
- Evidence that the agent refuses to invent information when content is missing.

- A short note on how instructions changed output quality.

Extension (optional)

- Refine instructions to enforce a 120-word maximum response.
- Add a new document and confirm the agent can answer questions grounded in the new content.